XCITY URBAN DESIGN AND AI PLANNING CALLS

Design Practice Call · Stage 1: call for qualifications

XCITY runs two separate calls on one site. This one, the **Design Practice Call**, looks for professional teams able to propose urban design of real spatial quality — teams worth commissioning to take it further. The other, the Open Agent Call, tests whether an AI agent can plan on its own; it has its own brief and review. The two share only the site and its conditions: `brief/site-conditions.en.md`.

Organiser	XCITY
Site	Parcels 9 and 13, San Juan, Argentina — 1,656 km². Shared conditions: `brief/site-conditions.en.md`; data: `brief/site-package/`
Procedure	Two stages: qualifications first; design by a shortlist
Languages	English, Spanish or Chinese
Contact	competition@xcity.ai

1. Procedure

Stage 1 · Qualifications (this document). Open to every practice that meets section 2. **No design is asked for**: we look at the practice, its relevant work and the core team. The organiser reviews the applications and draws up a shortlist. No practice carries design work before the terms of that work are known.

Stage 2 · Design, by the shortlisted teams. Shortlisted teams receive a **brief of their own** — not the Open Agent Call's — together with the full site package, an online briefing and a written question period. The design focus is the overall spatial structure, key districts, and the quality of streets, blocks and public space. Deliverables are a design statement, a master plan, analysis drawings, and drawings of key districts and nodes. Every team that delivers a compliant entry receives an honorarium.

Review and selection. A jury reviews the stage-two entries on response to the site, spatial quality, professional completeness and potential for delivery. Shortlisted teams present online. Selected teams move to further work with XCITY, on terms set out with the stage-two brief.

2. Who can apply

- The team is led by a legally constituted practice in urban design, urban planning, landscape architecture or architecture.
- The lead has completed or led at least one masterplan, new district or new town at district scale (100 ha or more) in the last fifteen years.

- The team covers urban design, landscape and ecology, energy and infrastructure, and water. Partners may be named at stage 1 or completed by stage 2.
- A firm may lead or join one team only.
- No Argentine partner is needed to apply. XCITY arranges local collaboration for the selected team.
- Organiser staff, jury members and their immediate families may not take part.
- Individuals, students and teams without a registered practice are welcome in the Open Agent Call.

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3. What to send

One PDF, at most **20 pages and 20 MB**, in English, Spanish or Chinese, containing:

1. **Letter of application** signed by the lead (1 page): practice name, contact person, team members and their roles. Use the application form, `templates/firm-application-form.docx` (Word), as this page.
2. **Practice profile** (up to 3 pages): size, offices, disciplines, relevant awards.
3. **Key people** (up to 4 pages): short CVs of the lead designer and the people who will work on the project.
4. **Reference projects**, three to five, up to 2 pages each: scale, your role, client, status, year. At least one is a masterplan or a new district.
5. **Approach statement** (up to 2 pages, no design): how you would meet this site — water, energy and compute, the agrivoltaic system already running, phasing, and how you would work with AI tools if you use them.

Attachments, not counted in the 20 pages:

- proof of professional registration or of legal constitution;
- a signed declaration that no member of the team has a conflict of interest with the organiser or the jury.

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4. How to apply

Email the PDF to **competition@xcity.ai** with the subject line `XCITY - Design Practice Call - <practice name>`. The organiser confirms receipt and may arrange a short online call while it reviews the qualifications.

Questions and answers

- Ask by email to **competition@xcity.ai** with the subject line `XCITY - Design Practice Call - Question`, or in public: open an Issue in this repository with `[firm-track]` at the start of the title.
- Every answer is published in this repository, the same for every applicant, without naming who asked. No answer is given privately.
- An answer explains the call; it does not change it. Changes are made only in the documents themselves and logged in `CHANGELOG.md`.
- The last date for questions is published with the formal rules.

5. How qualifications are assessed

1. Relevance of the experience to this project — scale, climate, new settlement, energy and water.
2. Quality of the reference work.
3. The range the team covers.
4. The approach statement: does it read the site, not a generic city?

6. Published with the formal rules

The application deadline, the size of the shortlist, the stage-two timeline, the jury, the honorarium, intellectual property, and the terms of further work for the selected team are published with the formal rules. From then on the formal rules govern, and changes are logged in `CHANGELOG.md`.

7. Materials

The site conditions and the site package are open to practices now; the stage-two brief goes to the shortlisted teams. Download it all at https://github.com/XcityUS/xcity-ai-competition/archive/refs/heads/main.zip.

Published with the repository github.com/XcityUS/xcity-ai-competition. Where this PDF and the repository differ, the repository governs.